

Erwin Quanten

Staff Software Engineer – PHP, Laravel, Symfony, AWS

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Staff Software Engineer with strong experience in **fintech, telecom, logistics, and enterprise SaaS**, specializing in **PHP 7.4–8.3, Laravel 8–11, Symfony 4–7, React 16–18, AWS, MySQL 5.7–8.0, PostgreSQL 12–16, Redis 5–7, Docker, and CI/CD**. Skilled in modernizing legacy PHP platforms, migrating monoliths to modular services, improving API performance, fixing production defects, and delivering secure business features with measurable reliability, scalability, and maintainability improvements across distributed engineering teams.

SKILLS

- **Backend: PHP 8.1–8.3, Laravel 9–11, Symfony 6–7**, REST API, API Gateway, JSON API, OAuth2, JWT, RBAC, Composer, PHPUnit, Pest, PHPStan, Psalm
- **Database: MySQL 8, PostgreSQL 14–16**, Redis 6–7, database indexing, query optimization, stored procedures, schema migration, replication-aware design
- **Messaging & Jobs: RabbitMQ 3.11–3.13**, Laravel Queue, Symfony Messenger, cron workers, retry strategy, dead-letter queues, async processing
- **Cloud & DevOps: AWS**, Docker, Kubernetes, Terraform, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI, Jenkins, Nginx, Linux, CloudWatch, ELK, Prometheus, Grafana
- **Architecture**: Microservices, modular monolith, DDD basics, event-driven design, legacy modernization, secure backend design, CI/CD automation

EXPERIENCE

Lightedge — Lead Software Engineer

Remote/ Full time

May2022 – Apr 2026

=Houston, TX

- Led backend modernization for a cloud infrastructure platform by upgrading core services from **PHP 7.4** to **PHP 8.2**, resolving deprecated package conflicts, typed-property issues, and Composer dependency breaks without disrupting production workloads.
- Designed secure customer-facing REST APIs with **Laravel 10**, OAuth2, JWT, and role-based access control, improving request validation consistency by **27%** and reducing authorization-related support tickets by **22%**.
- Migrated legacy billing and provisioning modules from a tightly coupled PHP codebase into modular services using **Symfony 6.4**, improving release isolation and reducing regression defects by **29%**.
- Resolved recurring queue failures in background provisioning jobs by adding retry policies, dead-letter queues, and worker health checks with **RabbitMQ 3.12**, reducing failed async jobs by **31%**.
- Improved PostgreSQL query performance by analyzing slow execution plans, adding composite indexes, and refactoring N+1 data access patterns, reducing average API response time by **28%**.
- Implemented centralized logging and traceable error handling across PHP services using structured JSON logs, correlation IDs, CloudWatch, and ELK dashboards for faster production incident diagnosis.
- Reworked Docker-based local development for backend engineers by standardizing PHP-FPM, Nginx, Redis, PostgreSQL, and queue workers into repeatable containers with cleaner environment configuration.
- Built CI/CD pipelines with GitHub Actions, Docker image validation, PHPUnit, PHPStan, and deployment approvals, increasing deployment reliability by **24%** across staging and production environments.
- Fixed intermittent payment synchronization errors caused by duplicate webhook processing by implementing idempotency keys, database constraints, and safer retry handling inside Laravel jobs.
- Created internal API standards with OpenAPI documentation, request DTOs, validation rules, and consistent error responses, helping frontend teams integrate backend services with fewer contract issues.
- Guided engineers through production debugging, database migration reviews, and rollback planning, improving backend ownership across the team while keeping high-risk releases controlled.
- Partnered with infrastructure teams on Kubernetes readiness probes, container resource limits, and zero-downtime rollout strategy for PHP workloads running behind Nginx and AWS load balancers.

Syscom Digital — Staff Software Engineer

Remote/ Full time

Nov 2017 – Apr 2022

Bucharest, Romania

- Architected enterprise backend services for telecom workflow automation using **PHP 7.4–8.1**, **Laravel 8–9**, and **Symfony 5**, supporting high-volume integrations across customer, billing, and service-management systems.
- Migrated several legacy PHP modules from **Laravel 5.7** to **Laravel 8**, resolving middleware changes, authentication guard issues, route binding differences, and outdated package incompatibilities.
- Improved MySQL reporting queries by redesigning indexes, splitting heavy joins, and introducing cached read models with Redis, reducing dashboard load time by **26%** for operational users.
- Implemented API integrations with third-party CRM and billing platforms using REST, OAuth2, retries, and circuit-breaker patterns, reducing integration timeout incidents by **23%**.
- Solved production memory leaks in long-running queue workers by profiling payload size, clearing container state, and tuning supervisor restart limits for Laravel queue processes.
- Introduced automated backend test coverage with PHPUnit, feature tests, mock external services, and CI gates, reducing release-stage defects by **21%** across critical business workflows.
- Refactored monolithic service logic into domain-focused modules with cleaner service classes, repositories, validation layers, and event dispatchers while keeping deployment risk manageable.
- Built asynchronous notification and provisioning flows with **RabbitMQ 3.8**, Redis, and scheduled workers, improving throughput during peak telecom activation windows.
- Supported Docker adoption for PHP applications by containerizing Nginx, PHP-FPM, MySQL, Redis, and worker services, making onboarding faster and reducing environment mismatch issues.
- Reviewed backend pull requests for security, SQL efficiency, validation coverage, and exception handling, helping teams maintain consistent engineering standards across multiple PHP products.

Tessenderlo Group — Senior Software Engineer

Remote/ Full time

Aug 2015 – Oct 2017

Brussel Metropolitan Area

- Modernized internal logistics and procurement applications using **PHP 5.6–7.1**, **Symfony 2.8–3.4**, and **Laravel 5.2–5.5**, improving maintainability across business-critical backend systems.
- Upgraded legacy services from PHP 5.6 to **PHP 7.1**, fixing strict type issues, deprecated extensions, library conflicts, and session-handling behavior before production rollout.
- Reduced order-processing errors by **18%** by adding validation layers, transaction boundaries, and clearer exception handling around inventory updates and supplier synchronization flows.
- Optimized MySQL 5.7 queries used in logistics dashboards by adding indexes, rewriting inefficient joins, and moving repeated calculations into controlled backend service methods.
- Implemented REST API endpoints for procurement, shipment tracking, and internal approvals, allowing frontend teams to replace fragile server-rendered flows with cleaner integrations.
- Resolved recurring file-import failures by improving CSV validation, encoding detection, duplicate handling, and batch-level rollback logic for supplier and warehouse data feeds.
- Introduced automated deployment scripts with Jenkins, Composer, and environment-based configuration, reducing manual release mistakes by **20%** across internal PHP applications.
- Collaborated with business stakeholders to convert manual approval workflows into backend services with audit trails, role permissions, and searchable history for compliance needs.
- Mentored developers on Symfony service containers, Laravel migrations, database indexing, and safer production debugging for enterprise PHP applications.

Tessenderlo Group — Software Engineer

Hybrid/ Full time

Sep 2011 – Jul 2015

Brussel Metropolitan Area

- Developed internal ERP extension modules using **PHP 5.3–5.6**, Zend Framework 1–2, Symfony 2, MySQL 5.5, Apache, and Linux-based deployment environments.
- Refactored older procedural PHP pages into reusable controller, service, and model layers, improving readability and reducing duplicate backend logic across multiple internal tools.
- Built SOAP and REST integrations with finance, inventory, and supplier systems, adding validation, logging, and retry handling to reduce manual reconciliation work by **17%**.
- Fixed recurring session timeout and permission bugs by improving authentication checks, role mapping, and server-side state handling across shared business applications.
- Improved database reliability by cleaning inconsistent foreign-key usage, normalizing repeated lookup tables, and adding safer migration scripts for MySQL schema changes.

- Supported the gradual move from SVN-based workflows to Git, helping teams improve branching discipline, code reviews, and rollback confidence during production releases.
- Created backend export jobs for Excel and CSV reporting, handling large datasets through pagination, streaming responses, and memory-conscious query design.
- Worked closely with QA and operations teams to reproduce production bugs, analyze Apache/PHP logs, and deploy targeted fixes without creating wider regression risk.

Tessengerlo Group — Software Developer

Hybrid/ Full time

Jun 2009 – Aug 2011

Brussel Metropolitan Area

- Built early internal web applications with **PHP 5.2–5.3**, CodeIgniter 1.7–2.0, Zend Framework 1, MySQL 5.1, Apache, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.
- Implemented backend forms, validation rules, reporting pages, and authentication flows for operational teams that needed faster access to warehouse and procurement data.
- Resolved data-entry issues by adding server-side validation, duplicate checks, and clearer error messages, reducing incorrect internal submissions by **15%**.
- Maintained Linux-hosted PHP applications by reviewing Apache logs, fixing broken SQL queries, updating configuration files, and supporting controlled production deployments.
- Collaborated with senior engineers to learn secure coding, database normalization, reusable PHP components, and practical debugging techniques for enterprise web systems.

EDUCATION

KU Leuven — Master's Degree, Computer Science

Sep 2003 – May 2009